



Don't buy an AC in 2025

Unless you read these 5 tips

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Buying an air conditioner in 2025 is a lot like picking a streaming service – there are too many options, each promising to be the best, and you just want something that cools your room without making you regret your purchase a month later. With rising temperatures and manufacturers stuffing their machines with all sorts of futuristic technology, it's easy to get distracted by the bells and whistles.

Inverter vs Non-Inverter AC

If you're still stuck in the 'non-inverter ACs are cheaper' mindset, it's time for a wake-up call. Inverter ACs have taken over the market, and for good reason. Unlike their older counterparts that switch on and off repeatedly, inverter ACs adjust their compressor speed dynamically. This means they run more efficiently, consume less power,

and maintain a stable room temperature. On the downside, the PCB used in inverter ACs can be expensive to repair when the time comes. Also, in peak summers when your AC runs at full loads – both options consume similar energy. It is in monsoons and non-peak seasons that inverter ACs do the saving. Yes, they cost more upfront, but we'd say they are a smarter choice.

Tonnage matters

If your AC is too small for your room, it'll keep running non-stop and barely cool the place. Too big? It'll cool too fast without dehumidifying properly, leaving you with that weird, sticky feeling that no one likes. The golden rule? A 1-ton AC works for rooms up to 120 sq. ft., 1.5-ton handles 120-180 sq. ft., and for anything bigger, go for a 2-ton unit. Of course, if your room is a glasshouse or gets direct sunlight all day, size up accordingly.

Energy ratings

That five-star sticker on ACs matters. Energy efficiency ratings from the Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE) give

you a good idea of how much electricity your AC is going to gulp down. A five-star AC in 2025 is way better than a five-star AC from five years ago, thanks to upgraded efficiency standards. But there's a catch – higher star ratings mean higher upfront costs. If you use your AC all day, investing in a five-star unit pays off in the long run. If you just need it for a few hours at night, a three-star model might be enough. Just try not to go below that.

AI could be useful. Maybe.

Like everything modern, ACs also now flaunt AI which is used for auto-climate adjustment by also factoring in user preferences, and, if marketing teams are to be believed, the ability to predict the weather before it happens. Realistically, you should be looking for features that actually improve cooling efficiency. Dual-inverter compressors provide better speed control, while 4D air circulation ensures uniform cooling. If you live in a humid area, look for dehumidification modes, and if your city feels like a furnace in May, high ambient cooling ensures the AC doesn't give up when temperatures cross 50°C.

Smart features count

A decade ago, turning on your AC with a remote felt futuristic. Now, if your AC doesn't come with Wi-Fi, voice control, or app integration, is it even worth it? Smart ACs let you control settings through your phone, schedule cooling times, and even respond to voice assistants. But are these add-ons truly worth it? If you're a tech enthusiast or like adjusting temperatures without moving an inch, smart ACs are worth it. Our favourite smart feature is the ability to track energy consumption and the option to set targets. **td**

